G PITCH FOR 2036

RTING EVENT IN GUJARAT, HERE IS WHAT THE STATE MUST DO



THE OLYMPICS ARE VERY MUCH ON GUJARAT'S MIND. YOU CAN SEE IT IN THE FRENETIC ACTIVITY at the 650-acre Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Sports Enclave coming up on the banks of the Sabarmati, in Ahmedabad's Motera area. Olympic rings made of colour-appropriate flowers were the main attraction at the annual flower show in Ahmedabad this January. A more permanent steel and cement symbol has come up outside the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Airport in the city.

Never mind that it will take another year for the International Olympic Committee (IOC) to decide who will host the 2036 event. India submitted a letter of intent (LoI) in October 2024. Though it did not specify any location, sources in Gandhinagar say a majority of the events will be hosted in Gujarat, and a few in Goa, Maharashtra, Uttarakhand and Madhya Pradesh. There is no ambivalence about where the opening and closing ceremonies will be held: at the Narendra Modi Cricket Stadium.